HUIQI ZHUANG

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EDUCATION

PhD in Economics, Indiana University 2025/5

References:

Ruli Xiao (Chair)
Department of Economics, IUB
rulixiao@iu.edu, (812) 855-3213

Stefan Weiergraeber
Department of Ecobomics, IUB
sweiergr@iu.edu, (812) 855-2146

Andrew Butters
Department of Business Economics and Public Policy, Kelley School of Business, IUB
rabutter@indiana.edu, (812) 855-5768

BS in Mathematical Economics & Finance, Xi'an Jiaotong University 2019/7
Visiting student, Columbia University 2017/9 - 2018/1

RESEARCH FIELDS

Primary fields: Empirical Industrial Organization, Environmental & Energy Economics
Secondary fields: Climate Policy, Cultural Economics, and Social Inequality

EMPLOYMENT EXPERIENCE

Assistant Professor of Finance, School of Finance, Nankai University 2025/9 - Present
Charles River Associates Washington D.C., U.S.A., 2023/6 - 2023/8

- Independently manage project teams consisting of five to ten researchers. Interface directly with clients, law firm associates and partners.
- Use Python and State to analyze data provided by the clients, including market analysis, labor analysis and counterfactural analysis.
- Formulate and oversee completion of economic analyses to deliver insights to clients and provide economic intelligence on multi-billion dollar M&A deals.
- Drafted economic project memos, sections of expert reports, and presentations to DOJ and FTC.

TEACHING EXPERIENCE

Teaching Assistant for

- ECON-E201 Intro to Microeconomics 2019 fall, 2020 spring
- ECON-E370 Stat Analysis for Business and Economics 2021 spring
- ECON-B251 Fund of Economics for Business 2021 fall, 2022 spring, 2022 fall

Associate Instructor for

- ECON-E370 Stat Analysis for Business and Economics 2020 fall, 2023 spring, 2023 Fall

HONORS AND AWARDS

- Best Student Authored Paper Conference on Health IT and Analytics (CHITA), 2022

- The First Prize Scholarship Xi'an Jiaotong University, 2016

SKILLS

Statistical Programs: Python, R, STATA, MATLAB, Latex
Languages: English (fluent), Chinese (native)

WORKING PAPERS

- *Shadows in the Sunlight: Do Solar Power's Benefits Shine Equally on Everyone?*
  I examine disparities in energy tax credit utilization and consumer welfare across different income groups, utilizing a detailed solar photovoltaic (PV) systems dataset from 'Tracking the Sun'. My analysis reveals a significant discrepancy in tax credit utilization rates; high-income households are three times more likely to adopt solar under these incentives compared to low-income households. Uniquely applying a BLP structural model, I quantify the barriers created by non-refundable tax credits for individuals with limited tax liability. The findings highlight a pronounced consumer surplus gap: low-income households average a surplus of just \$493, markedly lower than the \$1,451 for higher-income counterparts. These welfare disparities are partly due to informational barriers and significantly influenced by tax liability constraints. Insightful counterfactual scenarios modeled in the BLP framework suggest that refundable tax credits could boost solar adoption among low-income households by 25%. Furthermore, increasing the credit to cover 40% of installation costs could increase their consumer surplus by an estimated \$717. These compelling findings underscore the urgent need for policy reform, advocating for more inclusive and equitable energy tax credit structures to bridge the socio-economic gap in renewable energy access.

- *Convenience vs. Confidentiality: Rethinking the Role of Online Purchases at the Era of Rising Privacy Concerns (with Ruli Xiao, Yajing Jiang and Jian Ni, R&R at Management Science)*
  Consumers leave traces of their shopping behavior both online and offline, which may raise some privacy concerns. Such concern was made salient in recent years during some high-profile data breaches and is amplified in health-related contexts because this purchase information could contain sensitive proprietary details. In this paper, we investigate how consumers' online/offline healthcare-product shopping behaviors are affected by increasing privacy concerns about possible health-information leaks. Our analysis leverages the California Consumer Privacy Act (CCPA), formally announced in 2018 as the primary law protecting consumers' data privacy rights. We find that the percentage of households' online shopping trips declined sharply after the CCPA announcement, relative to their offline shopping trips. This effect was more pronounced for health products such as male enhancement products and weight-control products. These findings suggest that consumers are aware of privacy issues and make conscious choices to protect their personal health data.

- *Green Energy Incentives: Unraveling the Impacts on Mortgage Markets and Socioeconomic Disparities*
  This research delves into the unprecedented impacts of residential renewable energy tax credits on the mortgage market, shedding light on the intricate dynamics that unfold when green initiatives intersect with housing finance. Through a comprehensive analysis, this study uncovers how such policies shape mortgage pricing, risk profiles, and lending practices. The findings indicate that properties benefiting from the tax credit experience higher prices and lower interest rates, suggesting that banks perceive renewable energy systems as enhancing property values and reducing default risk. Moreover, it explores the differential impacts on low-income and high-income homeowners, providing insights into the potential socioeconomic disparities that can arise. By examining the interplay between environmental incentives and mortgage market outcomes, this research deepens our understanding of the complexities surrounding the pursuit of a sustainable and equitable future.

Work in Progress

- *Shattered Dreams: Unveiling Discrimination in the Reverse Mortgage Market*
- *The Self-fulfilling Prophecy of Superstition by Chinese zodiac sign (with Nathan Nunn)*